

Islamic Studies Assignment # 2

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Section: A

Q) Explain the basic principles of the Islamic Political System, Monotheism, Prophet hood, & Caliph in the light of Quran & Hadith.

1. Monotheism (Tawheed) – Sovereignty of Allah

Definition:

Tawheed is the core of Islamic belief, asserting that **Allah is One**, with no partners in His Lordship, Worship, or Names and Attributes. All human affairs, including governance, must be subordinate to **His Will and Law**.

Types of Tawheed in Governance:

1. **Tawheed al-Rububiyyah (Lordship):** Allah alone controls and governs the universe.
2. **Tawheed al-Uluhiyyah (Worship):** Only Allah is worthy of worship, including obedience in legislation.
3. **Tawheed al-Asma wa-Sifat (Names & Attributes):** Allah alone possesses perfect attributes, including justice and wisdom, essential in a political leader.

Political Implications:

- **No human being is sovereign.**
- Legislation and governance must derive from **divine revelation (Shari'ah)**, not human whims.

Qur'anic References:

- **"The decision is only for Allah. He has commanded that you worship none but Him."**
(*Surah Yusuf 12:40*)
- **"To Allah belongs the dominion of the heavens and the earth."**
(*Surah Ash-Shura 42:49*)
- **"And judge between them by what Allah has revealed..."**
(*Surah Al-Ma'idah 5:49*)

Hadith:

- The Prophet ﷺ said:
"He who obeys me, obeys Allah; he who disobeys me, disobeys Allah."
(*Bukhari and Muslim*)

2. Prophethood (Risalah) – Model of Governance and Law

Definition:

Risalah refers to the institution of **Prophethood**, where Allah sent messengers to guide mankind. The last prophet, **Muhammad ﷺ**, delivered the **final message** and acted as both **religious and political leader**.

Roles of the Prophet in a Political Context:

- **Spiritual leader:** Guided people to Tawheed.
- **Judge:** Settled disputes with divine justice.
- **Legislator:** Conveyed Allah's laws.
- **Military Commander:** Led in defense of the Muslim Ummah.
- **Head of State:** Established the first Islamic state in Madinah.

Qur'anic References:

- **"We sent them with clear signs and scriptures. And We sent down the Reminder to you, [O Muhammad], so you may explain to mankind what was revealed to them..."**
(*Surah An-Nahl 16:44*)
- **"Indeed, in the Messenger of Allah, you have a beautiful example..."**
(*Surah Al-Ahzab 33:21*)
- **"Whoever obeys the Messenger has obeyed Allah."**
(*Surah An-Nisa 4:80*)

Hadith:

- The Prophet ﷺ said:
"The children of Israel used to be ruled and guided by prophets: When a prophet died, another would succeed him. But after me, there will be no prophet; only Caliphs."
(*Sahih Bukhari*)

3. Caliphate (Khilafah) – Practical Implementation of Islam

Definition:

Khilafah means **succession** — the system of governance established after the Prophet's death to uphold **Shari'ah**, maintain **order**, and ensure **justice and welfare** in accordance with Islamic principles.

Purpose of Khilafah:

- Implement the laws of Allah.
- Ensure justice ('Adl).
- Protect the Ummah.
- Promote welfare and economic balance.
- Preserve public morals and social harmony.

Characteristics of a Caliph:

- Must be a **pious, just, and capable Muslim**.
- Selected through **Shura (consultation)** or public allegiance (Bay'ah).
- Must uphold and implement **Qur'an and Sunnah**.
- Removable if they **deviate from Islam or become unjust**.

Qur'anic References:

- **"Indeed, I will make a vicegerent on earth (Khalifah)."**
(*Surah Al-Baqarah 2:30*)

- **“Allah has promised to those among you who believe and do righteous deeds that He will surely grant them succession [Khilafah] upon the earth...”**
(Surah An-Nur 24:55)

Hadith References:

- **“The Caliphate in my Ummah will last thirty years, then there will be monarchy.”**
(Abu Dawood, Hadith 4646)
- **Abu Bakr’s inaugural speech:**
“O People! I have been appointed over you, though I am not the best among you. If I do well, help me; and if I act wrongly, correct me... Obey me as long as I obey Allah and His Messenger...”

Pillars of the Islamic Political System

Pillar	Explanation	Qur'an/Hadith
1. Sovereignty of Allah	Only Allah has the authority to legislate	Qur'an 12:40
2. Rule of Law (Shari'ah)	All are equal under divine law	Qur'an 5:49
3. Consultation (Shura)	Decisions through mutual consultation	Qur'an 42:38
4. Justice ('Adl)	Central objective of the state	Qur'an 4:135
5. Accountability	Ruler is a servant of the people	Hadith: “Every one of you is a shepherd...” (Bukhari)
6. Unity of Ummah	Islam unites people across race and region	Qur'an 49:10
7. Welfare (Maslahah)	Public interest is protected	Example: Prophet established Bayt al-Mal
8. Freedom of Religion	Non-Muslims protected (Dhimmah)	Qur'an 2:256 “No compulsion in religion”

Rights and Duties Under the Islamic State

For Citizens:

- Right to justice
- Right to freedom of belief and property
- Right to education and welfare
- Right to security and dignity

For Non-Muslims (Dhimmis):

- Full protection of life and property
- Right to practice religion
- Exempt from military duty
- Obligated to pay Jizyah (tax in return for protection)

For the Ruler:

- Duty to implement Allah's law
- Must maintain justice and equity
- Ensure security, development, and accountability
- Forbidden to be tyrannical or unjust

Examples from the Rightly Guided Caliphs (Khulafa-e-Rashideen)

- **Abu Bakr (R.A.):** Emphasized accountability and justice.
- **Umar (R.A.):** Established welfare system (Bayt al-Mal), judicial reforms.
- **Uthman (R.A.):** Compiled the Qur'an, expanded Islamic territory.
- **Ali (R.A.):** Emphasized knowledge and justice during internal strife.

Conclusion:

The **Islamic Political System** is not a theocracy ruled by clergy or a secular democracy with human-made laws. Instead, it is a **balanced system** of divine guidance, ethical leadership, and social justice. Its foundation is **Tawheed**, its methodology is **Prophethood**, and its practical structure is **Khilafah**.

The system promotes:

- Justice
- Equality before law
- Welfare of all citizens
- Accountability of rulers
- Rule of divine law (Shari'ah)

It offers a comprehensive model for governance that integrates **faith, ethics, law, and politics**, ensuring both **spiritual and worldly prosperity**.